Level 4 Adult ESL Curriculum: Scope and Sequence

Status: Plan approved on October 22, 2026, with the decisions in Section 8. All 13 lesson books, slide decks, and listening files are published.

Date: October 22, 2026

Audience: Program coordinators and the curriculum author (for review before any Level 4 lessons are built)

Sits directly above: the Level 3 curriculum (level3/curriculum/Level3_Scope_and_Sequence.md, 13 lessons, Week 8 midterm, Week 15 final, Week 16 graduation). **Sits below:** Level 5 (outline only; see Five_Level_Map.md).

> **Topics:** experiences and opinions in work, health, home, and community life: life experiences, how long you've lived and worked somewhere, checking work that's done, health history and preventive care, asking for favors, imaginary situations, cultural expectations, local news, community meetings, saving energy and home safety, time off and travel, scams, and your story so far.

How this document is organized

Section	What's inside
1. Rationale and research basis	Who Level 4 is for, and the frameworks it is based on
2. Entry and exit skills	What learners can do at the start and at the end
3. Handoff from Level 3 and to Level 5	What Level 4 assumes, what it adds, what it leaves for Level 5, and what changed from the five-level outline
4. Course design	The weekly routine, group sizes, language support, grammar format, materials, assessment and progress checks
5. Semester at a glance	One table for all 16 weeks, and where every grammar strand is taught
6. Week by week	Every lesson: theme, can-do goals, grammar Q&A, words, listening, Read & Write, Talk Time, exit ticket
7. Midterm, final, and graduation	What each one covers and how it works
8. Decisions	The seven review decisions (approved), recorded for the lesson build

1. Rationale and Research Basis

1.1 Why a Level 4, and who it is for

Level 3 graduates can keep a conversation going with follow-up questions and reasons, tell what happened with the past continuous, say how life used to be, offer help with *will*, and say what will happen *if*…. What they usually **can't** do yet is talk about **experiences that connect the past and the present** (*I've worked here since 2022. Have you ever…?*), talk about **imaginary situations** (*If I had more time, I'd…*), say what **might** happen, and **give and defend an opinion** politely. Those are the skills adults need for a health history form, a talk with a supervisor, a community meeting, a news report, or a suspicious phone call. Level 4 teaches them.

Target learner: an adult who finished Level 3 (or places at that level) and can hold a conversation on familiar topics with some help. About 95% speak Spanish; the rest speak a range of other languages. Most read and write in their first language. Some are repeating learners who want more speaking practice.

1.2 Level estimates (our estimate, not an official alignment)

Framework	Level 3 (existing)	Level 4 (this course)	Level 5 (planned)
NRS Educational Functioning Levels for ESL (U.S. Department of Education, adult education reporting)	High Beginning → **Low Intermediate ESL**	Starts at **Low Intermediate ESL**; aims to finish at **High Intermediate ESL**	High Intermediate → **Advanced ESL**
CEFR (Council of Europe; "plus" levels from the 2020 *Companion Volume*)	A2 → A2+	**A2+ → B1**	B1 → B1+ (moving toward B2)
CASAS	Same life-skill content areas (see 1.3). CASAS tests can report learners on the NRS levels. We **do not** claim any score alignment	Same	Same

What these levels describe, in plain words (paraphrased):

- **NRS Low Intermediate ESL:** the learner understands familiar phrases and some new ones spoken slowly with repetition, can ask and answer questions, and can take part in some routine social conversations, though with some difficulty.
- **NRS High Intermediate ESL:** the learner understands short new phrases on familiar topics, can take part in limited conversations, and has inconsistent control of more complex grammar.
- **CEFR A2+:** the stronger half of A2: the learner takes a more active part in conversation (with some help) and handles a wider range of everyday situations.
- **CEFR B1:** the learner understands the main points of clear speech on familiar matters (work, school, free time), deals with most everyday situations, connects sentences to describe experiences, events, hopes, and plans, and gives short reasons and explanations.

The Level 4 exit goal is NRS High Intermediate and CEFR B1, applied to work, family, health, and community situations. The can-do lists in Section 2 are written to match.

> **Note on test scores:** CASAS publishes score ranges for each NRS level, and the ranges differ by test series and year. Newer NRS descriptors are aligned with the federal English Language Proficiency Standards for adult education. If the program needs scores for reporting, use the current official tables, not this document.

1.3 Content areas (CASAS-style life skills)

Content area	Level 4 lessons
Basic communication (experiences, opinions, imaginary situations, life stories)	1, 2, 6, 9, 13
Consumer economics (scams, utility bills, insurance card basics)	4, 10, 12
Community resources (local news, community meetings, travel)	8, 9, 11
Health (health history, ongoing symptoms, dental and preventive care)	4
Employment (task check-ins, shift switches, dress codes, being on time, time off)	3, 5, 7, 11
Independent living / housing (applications, neighbors, locks, home safety, utilities, saving energy)	2, 5, 10
Learning skills (problem solving, comparing customs, telling your story, next steps)	6, 7, 13, and every week

1.4 Teaching principles (and where they come from)

Principle	What it means in Level 4	Basis
Three sentences, not one	Every Talk Time and every exit ticket asks for an answer of about three connected sentences: the answer, a reason, and a detail or example.	CEFR B1 descriptors for connecting sentences and giving short reasons and explanations
Grammar through real tasks	Each grammar point is tied to one real job: present perfect → a health history form; *Would you mind…?* → asking a neighbor for a favor; *might* → understanding a news report; *who / that* → spotting a scam.	Task-based language teaching (for example, Rod Ellis, *Task-Based Language Learning and Teaching*, 2003)
Explicit, easy-to-explain grammar	Every box has a one-line "rule of thumb" and, for the present perfect, a timeline the teacher can draw. Volunteers never need grammar terms beyond the box.	Focus on form within meaning-focused tasks
Pictures with every word	Every vocabulary word has a picture card, as in Levels 1–3.	Dual coding (Allan Paivio)
Many meetings with each word	Each word appears in New Words, the listening, the grammar box, Talk Time, Read & Write, the homework, and later lessons. Learners keep their own word list.	Paul Nation, *Learning Vocabulary in Another Language*
Listen for the main idea, then details	The audio is longer, at natural speed, and it uses the full forms *going to* and *want to*. A text tip teaches that people often say *gonna* and *wanna*. The first listen is for gist and the second for details.	Common listening-instruction practice (pre-, while-, and post-listening stages)
Lots of pair and group talk	Every lesson has at least three pair or group tasks, and Talk Time is 3 minutes longer than in Level 3. Target: learners talk for more than half of the class time.	Same principle as Levels 1–3

2. Entry and Exit Skills

2.1 Entry (who should start in Level 4)

A learner belongs in Level 4 if, in a short placement chat, they **can** do most of these:

- tell a short story in the past with *when* or *while* (*I was waiting for the bus when it started to rain*)
- say how life used to be (*I used to live on a farm*)
- say what they will do *if* something happens, with a reason (*If it rains, I'll take the bus, because I don't have an umbrella*)

…but **cannot yet** comfortably do most of these:

- answer *Have you ever…?* and *How long have you lived here?* correctly (*I've lived here for three years*, not *I live here since three years*)
- talk about an imaginary situation (*If I had more time, I would…*)
- disagree politely (*I see your point, but…*)

Learners who can't yet do the first list probably belong in Level 3. Learners who can do both lists probably belong in Level 5.

2.2 Exit (what learners can do at the end = what Level 5 expects)

Talking and listening: learners can…

- talk about life experiences (*Have you ever…?*) and how long (*for / since*)
- describe their health history and an ongoing symptom (*I've had this rash since Monday*)
- say what has and hasn't been done yet at work (*I've already restocked the shelves. I haven't cleaned the cooler yet*)
- ask a neighbor or coworker for a favor, and answer one politely (*Would you mind…? No, not at all*)
- talk about imaginary situations (*If I had…, I would…*)
- give, ask for, and politely disagree with an opinion
- tell about life events in order (*before, after, when*)
- talk about cultural expectations such as being on time and workplace dress
- understand the main points of a short local news report
- recognize a scam and say what to do
- talk about possibility (*It might close early*)
- ask for time off, plan a trip, and leave a detailed voicemail
- give a 2-minute talk about their story and next step

Reading and writing: learners can…

- read texts of 150–250 words (notices, emails, an employee handbook page, a utility bill and flyer, a short news article, an advice column) and find the main idea and key details

- write a short email of 5–8 sentences (an update, a favor, a time-off request, a warning to a friend)
- write a short opinion paragraph (5–7 sentences) with a topic sentence, two reasons, and a closing sentence

Grammar they control (in practiced situations): present perfect (*ever / never, for / since, already / yet / just*) and present perfect vs. simple past; suggestions (*could, why don't you, it's a good idea to*); *Would you mind…?*; second conditional; *too / enough, too much / too many*; *must / mustn't / don't have to*; *might / may / could* for possibility; *Do you know where…?*; agreeing and disagreeing; *as … as*; separable phrasal verbs; infinitive of purpose; verb + infinitive vs. verb + *-ing*; defining relative clauses with *who / that*; time clauses with *before / after / when*; *could / was able to* for past ability.

Deliberately NOT in Level 4 (Level 5 teaches these): present perfect continuous (*How long have you been working…?*; Level 4 uses *How long have you worked…?*), past perfect, *wish*, third conditional, passive voice, reported speech, embedded questions with *if / whether* (Level 4 uses only *Do you know where / when / what time / why…?*), tag questions, modals of deduction (*It must be…*), relative clauses with *which / where* and object relative clauses as a taught point, and *unless / as long as*.

3. Handoff from Level 3 and to Level 5

3.1 What Level 3 teaches and Level 4 assumes

Level 4 Lesson 1 opens with a **brief** past-tense warm-up, then moves straight to the present perfect. Everything below is **not re-taught**; it appears only in the 6:00 Opening Talk, in a homework item, or as support for a new point.

Level 4 assumes learners know…	Level 3 teaches it in	Where Level 4 uses it
Follow-up questions; *because / so*	Lesson 1	Every Talk Time and exit ticket; Lesson 9 (opinions); Lesson 13 (with *before / after / when*)
look like / be like; object pronouns	Lesson 2	Lesson 3 (*I've cleaned it*); Lesson 10 (*turn it off*); Lesson 12 (*a man who…*)
used to	Lesson 3	Lesson 2 (*I used to live…, but I've lived here since…*); Lesson 13
Past continuous + *when / while*	Lesson 4	Lesson 8 (news); Lesson 13 (longer life stories)
will (offers, decisions, predictions); *will* vs. *going to*	Lessons 5, 6, 13	Lesson 5 (*Sure, I'll do it*); Lesson 8 (*will* vs. *might*); Lesson 11 (plans)
First conditional	Lesson 6	Lesson 6 contrasts it with the second conditional; Lesson 13 (*When I finish…, I'll…*)
I'd like to + verb; *Could I / May I…?*	Lesson 7	Lesson 5 (*Would you mind…?*); Lesson 11 (*I'd like to request…*)
Possessive pronouns; *Whose…?*	Lesson 8	Lesson 5 (borrowing: *Could I borrow yours?*), review only
good at / interested in / enjoy / don't mind + *-ing*	Lesson 9	Lesson 11 (verb + *-ing* vs. verb + infinitive)
Sequence words + imperatives; *Don't…*	Lesson 10	Lesson 10 (*Make sure you… / Don't forget to…*); Lesson 11 (packing)
-ed / -ing adjectives; *I thought it was…*	Lesson 11	Lesson 1 (*How was it? It was exciting*); Lesson 9 (opinions)
something / anything / someone / anyone…	Lesson 12	Lesson 12 (*Never give your PIN to anyone*)
hope to / plan to / want to; a 1–2 minute talk	Lesson 13	Lesson 11 (verb + infinitive list); Lesson 13 (a 2-minute talk)

Items Level 3 passed to Level 4 (from its "Deliberately NOT in Level 3" list): present perfect → **Lessons 1–4**; second conditional → **Lesson 6**; *too / enough* (Level 3 used *too small* only as a fixed phrase) → **Lesson 7**; *might / may* (Level 3 used *maybe, probably*) → **Lesson 8**; indirect questions → **Lesson 8**; phrasal verbs as a grammar point → **Lesson 10**; gerund vs. infinitive → **Lesson 11**; relative clauses → **Lesson 12**.

Planned overlap (on purpose): a few earlier words come back with new grammar: *cough, dentist, appointment* (Level 2 Lesson 10 → Lesson 4), *insurance card* (Level 3 Lesson 4 → Lesson 4), *shift* (Level 3 Lesson 9 → Lesson 5), *lock, smoke alarm* (Level 3 Lesson 12 → Lesson 10), *turn on / turn off, plug in* (Level 3 Lesson 10 → Lesson 10, now as phrasal verbs), *pick up, fill out* (Level 2 → Lessons 2 and 10),

password (Level 3 Lesson 10 → Lesson 12). They are **not** on the Level 4 picture pages. Otherwise, Level 4 vocabulary is chosen not to repeat the Level 1–3 picture pages.

3.2 What Level 4 gives Level 5

Level 5 will assume…	Level 4 teaches it in	Level 5 builds…
Present perfect (*ever, for / since, already / yet*)	Lessons 1–4	present perfect continuous (*How long have you been working…?*)
Simple past and present perfect together	Lessons 2, 13	past perfect (*I had already left when…*)
Second conditional	Lesson 6	*wish*; third conditional (light)
might / may / could	Lesson 8	modals of deduction (*It must be… It can't be…*)
Do you know where…?	Lesson 8	embedded questions with *if / whether*
Giving and defending opinions; *as … as*	Lesson 9	negotiating and compromising
Defining relative clauses (*who / that*)	Lesson 12	*which, where*
Verb + *-ing* vs. infinitive	Lesson 11	gerunds as subjects (*Saving money is hard*)
Time clauses (*before / after / when*)	Lesson 13	*by the time*; *unless, as long as*
5–8 sentence emails; an opinion paragraph; a 2-minute talk	Read & Write, every week; Lesson 13	1–2 paragraph letters; a 2–3 minute organized talk

3.3 Changes from the five-level outline (moved, merged, or limited)

Every exit can-do, core grammar strand, and life-skill theme in the Level 4 outline (Five_Level_Map.md) is assigned to a lesson (see 5.1). **Nothing was dropped.** These items were moved, merged, or limited, and why:

Outline item	What this plan does	Why
could (three meanings in the outline and strand table)	Taught in three places, each with a label: **suggestion** (Lesson 4, *You could try…*), **possibility** (Lesson 8, *It could open next week*), **past ability** (Lesson 13, *I couldn't… / I was able to…*)	One word, three jobs; volunteers explain one job at a time
must / mustn't (strand table, Level 4 = P)	Placed in Lesson 7 with workplace rules and dress codes	Not in the outline's core list, but it fits workplace rules and contrasts with *don't have to* (Level 2)
could / was able to for past ability (strand table, Level 4 = P)	Placed in Lesson 13 (life stories)	What you couldn't do before and can do now is the heart of the graduation talk
as … as / not as … as (strand table, Level 4 = P)	Placed in Lesson 9 (opinions) as practice of comparatives	Comparing two plans is how people support an opinion
"Give, ask for, and politely disagree with an opinion"	Taught as a functional-language box in Lesson 9, not a grammar strand	There is no single structure for it; the box gives fixed phrases

Outline item	What this plan does	Why
Health history, insurance basics, dental and preventive care	All in Lesson 4; insurance is limited to reading an insurance card and the words *copay* and *deductible* (Decision 3)	One health lesson keeps the topic practical and calm; insurance claims are a Level 5 theme
"Ask for time off and plan a trip," "leave a detailed voicemail," travel and packing	Merged into Lesson 11	One real situation (time off to visit family) needs all three
Local news and community meetings	Split: news in Lesson 8, a community meeting in Lesson 9	News pairs with *might*; meetings pair with opinions
Workplace theme (performance, scheduling, time off, dress codes)	Spread over Lessons 3 (checking tasks, a check-in), 5 (switching a shift), 7 (dress codes, being on time), 11 (time off)	Workplace English comes back four times; "performance" is a short, positive check-in, not a formal review
Housing theme (locks, home safety, utilities, saving energy)	Lesson 10, plus neighbors and a spare key in Lesson 5 and a rental application in Lesson 2	Home repairs were Level 3 Lesson 12; Level 4 moves to prevention and bills
Phrasal verbs	Only **separable** verbs with an object are taught (8 verbs); others (*get on, look for*) appear as vocabulary only	Separable verbs have one clear rule (*turn it off*) that volunteers can explain
Defining relative clauses	Subject clauses only (*a man who called, a text that asks…*); *the man (that) I met* is recognize only	Keeps the box to one pattern; Level 5 adds more
Indirect questions	A first look in Lesson 8: *Do you know where / when / what time / why…?* + statement order	The outline calls it a first look; *if / whether* is Level 5
Time clauses	Lesson 13, including future time clauses (*After I finish this class, I'll…*)	Links to the first conditional rule (no *will* after *if / when*)

4. Course Design

4.1 Weekly routine (same shape as Level 3, with longer Talk Time)

Learners coming from Level 3 will recognize every step. Level 4 changes four things: the audio is **longer and closer to natural speech** (some reductions), **Talk Time gets 3 more minutes** (15), the **Read & Write block runs 7:15–7:30** every week, and the **exit ticket is a 3-sentence answer with a reason**, written in the last 5 minutes of that block.

Clock time	Step	About	What happens
6:00–6:08	1. **Opening Talk + Homework Check**	8 min	Same partner for both. A question card on last week's grammar; partners answer in **3 sentences** and ask one follow-up question. Then compare homework. The teacher corrects only 2 items on the board. Late arrivals join a pair.
6:08–6:15	2. **New Words**	7 min	Picture page: point, say, repeat; a quick pair game. Learners add any word they want to their **personal word list** (the *My language* column; optional).
6:15–6:30	3. **Listening + "Hear it, say it"**	15 min	Before you listen → **Play 1:** Task A (main idea) → press play again → **Play 2:** Tasks B and C (details, grammar fill-in) → "Hear it": a text tip that *gonna* and *wanna* mean *going to* and *want to* (the audio itself uses the full forms) → repeat 2 lines. A third play is OK if the class needs it.
6:30–6:45	4. **Grammar Q&A + pair check**	15 min	The two-sided question/answer box; rule of thumb; Questions and answers; Common mistakes; an optional contrast tip where a common mix-up exists; then 3–5 minutes of pair practice.
6:45–7:00	**BREAK**	15 min	
7:00–7:15	5. **Talk Time**	15 min	The main pair or group activity of the night, usually in two rounds. Every answer needs a reason; every partner asks a follow-up.
7:15–7:25	6. **Read & Write**	10 min	A real-world text (150–250 words) with 4–5 questions, then a writing task (an email of 5–8 sentences, a form, or an opinion paragraph). Learners start the writing in class and finish it as homework.
7:25–7:30	7. **Exit Ticket + Homework**	5 min	**Never skip.** A 3-sentence answer to one question, with today's grammar and a reason. Do homework item 1 together.

> **Timing is loose on purpose.** If the listening or Talk Time runs long, take the time from Read & Write. If you're running behind, skip in this order: (1) the Read & Write writing task (it becomes homework); (2) the pair check at the end of Grammar; (3) the second round of Talk Time. **Never skip** the listening tasks, the grammar box and mistakes table, and the exit ticket.

4.2 Group sizes: every activity has a large-group and a small-group version

Classes start with about 15 learners and often drop to 7–8. Each lesson's Talk Time in Section 6 lists a **15**, a **7–8**, and a **5 or fewer** version. The other steps work like this every week:

Step	15 learners	7–8 learners	5 or fewer
Opening Talk	Pairs (one group of 3 if odd)	Pairs	Pairs, or one group with the teacher
New Words game	Pairs, then 3 teams for a quick team round	Pairs, then 2 teams	One team against the clock
Listening tasks	Individually, then check in pairs	Same	Check together as a group
Grammar pair check	Pairs; swap partners once	Pairs	Pairs; the teacher joins one
Read & Write	Pairs read and answer; individual writing	Same	Read aloud together; individual writing
Exit ticket	Individual, on paper	Same	Same, or spoken to the teacher and then written

4.3 Language support: tapering from Level 3 (proposed)

Level 3 has no Spanish line under instructions, a task-words page with *Español* and *My language* columns, a *My language* column on the New Words page, and on each Grammar page one short Spanish note and one tip for speakers of other languages. Level 4 learners know the routine well, so support moves from translation to **contrast**: noticing where English works differently from the learner's own language.

Support	Level 4 proposal	Why
Instruction icons	**None** (decided for all levels)	Instructions are short, plain English with the same task words every week
Spanish line under each instruction	**None** (as in Levels 2 and 3)	Learners know the task words
"My language" line under each instruction	**None**	Not needed at this level
Task-words page	Optional reference page at the **back** of the workbook (Decision 1)	Learners new to the program can still use it; others skip it
Personal word list	**Keep** the *My language* column on the New Words page (optional; filled in by the learner)	A personal bilingual list stays useful for new, less concrete words
Spanish note + tip for other languages	**Replaced** by an optional **"Contrast tip"** box, only on Grammar pages where a common mix-up exists (Decision 2), written for any language, with Spanish as one example	Fair to every learner; still catches the most common Spanish-transfer errors
Teacher pages	English only, as always	Teachers need no Spanish

> **Teacher-friendly:** volunteers never read, translate, or explain the contrast tip aloud; it is for learners to read on their own. When a learner is stuck: show it (picture, gesture, board timeline), give one more English

> example, point to the grammar box, let a classmate help for a few seconds, then back to English.

4.4 Grammar format: two-sided question-and-answer boxes

Same format as Levels 1–3: the question side on the left, the answer side on the right, one word from each column. Each box has a one-line **rule of thumb** in plain words, a short "Questions and answers" section, a "Common mistakes" table (✕ → ✓), and, where a common mix-up exists, an optional contrast tip (student pages only). Level 4 boxes have up to 6 rows, and the present perfect lessons add a **timeline** the teacher draws on the board (a line from "my life" to "now," with X's for experiences). Example (Lesson 2):

QUESTION			ANSWER		
How long **have**	you they	lived here?	I**'ve** They**'ve** lived here	**for**	three years. six months.
How long **has**	he she	worked there?	He**'s** She**'s** worked there	**since**	2022. March.
Have	you	ever moved?	Yes,	I	**have**.
			No,	I	**haven't**.
When **did**	you	move here?	I **moved** here	in	2021. three years ago.

Rule of thumb (Lesson 2): still true now → *have / has* + past participle. Finished, with a past time → simple past. *for* + a length of time; *since* + a starting point.

4.5 Materials per lesson (same as Levels 1–3)

Item	Level 4 detail
Student Workbook pages	New Words (with a *My language* column), Listening, Grammar, Talk Time sheet, Homework, and a Read & Write page. No instruction icons. Same page look as Level 3.
Pictures	12 per lesson (≈ 156 total), 600×420 PNG cards made from Twemoji graphics (CC BY 4.0), same style as Levels 1–3, named L4_L<lesson>_<word>.png (for example L4_L10_thermostat.png) so they never collide with Level 1–3 files. Abstract words (*milestone*, *suspicious*, *reference*, *copay*, *deadline*) get a labeled combination of two emoji or a simple form picture with the field highlighted. Avoid emoji with unclear or mixed meanings (for example, folded hands). Every picture gets a line in CREDITS.md.
Listening audio	One MP3 per lesson + midterm + final (15 files), Chatterbox TTS cloned from **synthetic reference voices only** (no recordings of real people), same pipeline as Level 3. **About 1:30–2:15**, **2–3 speakers**, natural speed, using *going to* and *want to* in the audio (Decision 5). **Female characters have clearly female voices and male characters clearly male voices** (each lesson in Section 6 lists the voices). Each file plays the conversation **once** (it never repeats inside the file); the teacher presses play again for the second listen.
Slides	One deck per lesson, same look as Level 3: picture words, listening tasks, the grammar box with click-to-reveal answers, Talk Time instructions, and the Read & Write text.
Teacher plan	At a glance, clock-time plan, step-by-step boxes, listening script, answer key, board timelines, and teacher notes in plain English. Every step says exactly what to say and show. **Teachers need no Spanish.**

4.6 Assessment and progress checks

Tool	When	What
Placement chat	Before Week 1 or on Week 1 night	3–4 minutes: the entry questions in Section 2.1. Decides Level 3, 4, or 5.
Baseline snapshot	Weeks 1–3	The same 6 prompts every time: *Have you ever…? (a place or a food) How long have you lived in this city? What have you done this week? What would you do if you had a free week? What do you think about (a class topic)? Tell me about an important day in your life.* About 5 learners per week during Talk Time. The final uses the same prompts to show growth.
Can-do self-check	Weeks 1, 8, 15	"I can…" lines + 😀 🙂 😐, read aloud by the teacher.
Exit ticket	Every lesson	A 3-sentence answer with today's grammar and a reason. The teacher sorts them into ✓ / almost / not yet and starts the next class with 2 corrections on the board.
Homework	Every lesson	15–20 minutes: finish the Read & Write writing, a speaking task with a family member or coworker, and one older grammar point.
Writing checks	Weeks 3, 7, 10, 12, 14	The teacher collects one writing task and writes one strength and one fix: Lesson 3 update email (Week 3), Lesson 7 first-week tips (Week 7), **Lesson 9 opinion paragraph** (Week 10), Lesson 11 time-off email (Week 12), Lesson 13 talk script (Week 14). Learners keep them in a folder to see progress.
Midterm / Final	Weeks 8, 15	Listening (the teacher plays the audio 2 times), grammar (circle + fix the mistake), a writing task (an email at the midterm; an opinion paragraph or email at the final), and a pair speaking interview with the same 1–3 rubric as Level 3. Section 7.

Progress-check calendar: Week 1: placement check, can-do self-check, baseline (about 5 learners) · Weeks 2–3: baseline (the rest) · Week 3: writing check 1 · Week 7: writing check 2 · Week 8: midterm, self-check, one goal · Week 10: writing check 3 (opinion paragraph) · Week 12: writing check 4 (email) · Week 14: talk rehearsal with peer feedback, writing check 5 · Week 15: final (baseline prompts repeated), self-check, "Ready for Level 5" decision.

5. The Semester at a Glance

Week	Class	Grammar Q&A focus	Real-life function
1	**Lesson 1 (Week 1):** Have You Ever…?	Present perfect for experiences: *Have you ever…? I've never…*; simple past for the details	Meet classmates through life experiences
2	**Lesson 2 (Week 2):** How Long Have You Lived Here?	*How long…? for / since*; present perfect vs. simple past	Give address and work history on an application
3	**Lesson 3 (Week 3):** Have You Finished Yet?	*already / yet / just*	Check tasks at work; a check-in with a supervisor; an update email
4	**Lesson 4 (Week 4):** How Long Have You Had It?	Present perfect for health history; suggestions: *could, why don't you, it's a good idea to*	Health history form, ongoing symptoms, dental and preventive care, insurance card
5	**Lesson 5 (Week 5):** Would You Mind…?	*Would you mind + -ing*? *Do you mind if I…?*; *Can / Could you…?*	Ask a neighbor or coworker for a favor; switch a shift
6	**Lesson 6 (Week 6):** What Would You Do?	Second conditional (*If I had…, I'd…*); *If I were you…*; first vs. second conditional	Talk about imaginary situations and everyday choices
7	**Lesson 7 (Week 7):** Too Early or On Time?	*too / enough*; *too much / too many*; *must / mustn't / don't have to*	Cultural expectations: being on time, dress codes, invitations
8	**Week 8: Midterm**	Review of Lessons 1–7	Review stations + exam
9	**Lesson 8 (Week 9):** In the News	*might / may / could* (possibility); *Do you know where / when…?*	Understand a short local news report
10	**Lesson 9 (Week 10):** I See Your Point	Giving, asking for, and disagreeing with opinions; *as … as / not as … as*	Take part in a community meeting; write an opinion paragraph
11	**Lesson 10 (Week 11):** Turn It Off	Separable phrasal verbs (*turn it off, put them away*)	Save energy, read a utility bill, keep a home safe
12	**Lesson 11 (Week 12):** Time Off	Infinitive of purpose (*to visit my sister*); verb + *to* vs. verb + *-ing*	Ask for time off, plan a trip, leave a detailed voicemail
13	**Lesson 12 (Week 13):** Is It a Scam?	Defining relative clauses (*who / that*)	Recognize a scam and say what to do
14	**Lesson 13 (Week 14):** My Story So Far	Time clauses (*before / after / when*); *could / was able to*	Tell life events in order; prepare the 2-minute graduation talk
15	**Week 15: Final Exam**	Review of all lessons (focus on 8–13)	Review stations + exam
16	**Week 16: Graduation**	—	2-minute "My Story So Far" talks; certificates

Grammar in teaching order: 1. present perfect for experiences (L1) → 2. *for / since*; present perfect vs. simple past (L2) → 3. *already / yet / just* (L3) → 4. suggestions; present perfect for health (L4) → 5. *Would you mind…?* (L5) → 6. second conditional (L6) → 7. *too / enough*; *must / mustn't* (L7) → **midterm** → 8. *might / may / could*; *Do you know where…?* (L8) → 9. opinions; *as … as* (L9) → 10. phrasal verbs (L10) →

11. infinitive of purpose; verb + *to* / *-ing* (L11) → 12. *who / that* (L12) → 13. time clauses; past ability (L13) → **final**.

5.1 Where every core grammar strand is taught

I = introduced (taught in a grammar box) · **P** = practiced / extended · **R** = reviewed (brief).

Strand (from the Level 4 outline and strand table)	Lesson(s)
Present perfect: *ever / never*	**I (1)**, P (4), R (12)
Present perfect: *for / since*	**I (2)**, P (4)
Present perfect: *already / yet / just*	**I (3)**, R (11)
Present perfect vs. simple past	**I (2)**, P (1, 3, 4, 13)
Second conditional (*would*); *If I were you*	**I (6)**, R (9)
might / may / could for possibility	**I (8)**
Suggestions: *could / why don't you / it's a good idea to* (builds on *should*)	**I (4)**, R (6)
too / enough; *too much / too many*	**I (7)**, R (10, 11)
Verb + infinitive vs. verb + *-ing*	**I (11)**
Infinitive of purpose	**I (11)**
Would you mind…? (builds on *Can / Could you…?*)	**I (5)**, R (11)
Defining relative clauses (*who / that*)	**I (12)**
Common separable phrasal verbs	**I (10)**
Do you know where…? (first look at indirect questions)	**I (8)**
Time clauses (*before / after / when*)	**I (13)**
Giving and disagreeing with opinions (function)	**I (9)**, P (exit tickets in 7 and 9)
must / mustn't / don't have to (strand table)	**P (7)**, R (12)
as … as / not as … as (strand table)	**P (9)**
could / was able to for past ability (strand table)	**P (13)**
Level 3 strands reviewed: *-ed / -ing* (1), *used to* (2, 13), object pronouns (3, 10), *will* (5, 8), first conditional (6, 13), possessive pronouns (5), imperatives + *Don't forget to* (10, 11), *something / anyone* (12), past continuous (8, 13), frequency words (7)	R

Spiral recycling: every Opening Talk reuses last week's questions, and every homework mixes in one older point. The present perfect (Lessons 1–4) comes back in almost every lesson after it is taught (*Have you ever gotten a text like this? I've already packed*). The second conditional (Lesson 6) returns in Lesson 9 (*If we had a playground, kids would…*), *too / enough* (Lesson 7) returns in Lessons 10 and 11 (*too much electricity, enough clothes*), and *Would you mind…?* (Lesson 5) returns in Lesson 11 (*Would you mind covering my shift?*).

6. Week by Week

Vocabulary: ★ = most important words. Each word gets a picture card. "Talk Time" is the main pair or group activity (7:00–7:15); each lesson also has pair work in New Words, Listening, and Grammar. The teacher plays the audio twice: Task A on the first play, Tasks B and C on the second. Grammar focus: ***I*** *= introduced,* ***P*** *= practiced / extended,* ***R*** *= reviewed. Voices: F = female voice, M = male voice.*

Lesson 1 (Week 1): Have You Ever…?

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	First night: getting to know classmates through life experiences (places, foods, jobs, things you've tried). Basic communication. Includes orientation, the personal word list, the first can-do self-check, and the baseline snapshot.
Can-do goals	I can ask *Have you ever…?* • I can answer *Yes, I have. / No, I've never…* • I can ask a follow-up in the past (*When did you…? How was it?*). • I can tell a classmate about one experience in 3 sentences.
Grammar Q&A focus	**R (5 min):** simple past warm-up: *What did you do last weekend?* • **I:** present perfect for experiences: *Have you ever worked in a restaurant? → Yes, I have. / No, I haven't. / No, never.* • *I've never seen snow. She's lived in three cities.* • *have / has* + past participle; a list of 20 common participles (*been, done, eaten, had, made, seen, taken, tried, worked, lived…*) • **P:** simple past for the details: *Have you ever been to Chicago? → Yes, I have. I went there in 2022. → How was it?* • **R:** *-ed / -ing* adjectives (Level 3 Lesson 11): *It was exciting.* • **Rule of thumb:** sometime in your life, no time → present perfect. Add a time (*in 2022, last year*) → simple past.
Vocabulary (12)	★ try (a new food) • ★ travel • ★ fly • ★ snow • ★ ocean • ★ mountain • ★ desert • ★ win a prize • ★ ride a horse • ★ run a race • go camping • see a famous person
Talk Time	**Round 1, Find Someone Who Has… (mingle):** a sheet of 10 *Have you ever…?* prompts. When someone says *Yes*, ask two follow-ups in the past (*When? Where? How was it?*) and write their name. **Round 2, Two True, One Invented:** each person says three *I've… / I've never…* sentences; the others ask follow-ups to find the invented one. **15:** whole-room mingle, then 5 groups of 3. **7–8:** mingle in one circle, then 2 groups. **5 or fewer:** one group; each person asks every other person 2 prompts.
Listening	**Situation:** two learners chat on the first night of an evening class at a community center; the teacher joins and asks them to find two things they have both done. **Speakers and voices:** Lucía, a learner (F); Ahmed, a learner (M); Ms. Grant, the teacher (F). **Target length:** about 1:45. **Tasks:** A: what have they both done? B: true / false on the details; C: write *have / has / did*.
Read & Write	**Read:** a "Meet Our Class" page with three short learner profiles (about 180 words total: *I've lived…, I've worked…, I've never…*). **Write:** a 5-sentence introduction email to the teacher: who you are, two experiences, one thing you've never done, and one goal for this class.
Exit ticket	*Tell me about something you have done (or never done).* 3 sentences: the experience, when it happened (or why not), and how it was, with *because* or *so*.
Pronunciation	Contractions *I've, she's (= she has), haven't*; weak *have* /həv/ in questions (*Have you ever…?*).
Contrast tip (optional)	Spanish has a similar form (*¿Alguna vez has trabajado…?*), but English never uses a finished time with it: *I worked there in 2020* (not *I've worked there in 2020*). What does your language do?
Teacher tip	Draw a timeline: one long line, "my life → now," with X's and no dates = present perfect. Learners choose what to share; places, foods, and jobs are always safe. Never ask how or when learners came to the U.S.

Lesson 2 (Week 2): How Long Have You Lived Here?

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	How long you've lived, worked, or studied somewhere; the address and work history part of an application (an apartment or a job). Housing and employment forms.
Can-do goals	I can ask and answer *How long have you…?* • I can use *for* and *since*. • I can choose the present perfect or the simple past. • I can fill out the address and work history part of an application.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** *for / since*: *How long have you lived here? → I've lived here for three years. / since 2023.* • *How long has she worked at the clinic? → Since March.* • *for* + a length of time; *since* + a starting point. • **I:** present perfect vs. simple past: *I've worked at the hotel since 2022.* (still true) vs. *I worked at a bakery for two years.* (finished) • *When did you move here? → In 2021. / Three years ago.* • **R:** *used to* (Level 3 Lesson 3): *I used to live with my cousins, but I've had my own apartment since 2023.* • **Rule of thumb:** see the example box in 4.4.
Vocabulary (12)	★ application • ★ current address • ★ previous address • ★ employer • ★ position (job title) • ★ start date • ★ end date • ★ reference (a person) • ★ for (two years) • ★ since (2020) • roommate • lease
Talk Time	**Round 1, Timeline Interviews:** each learner draws a simple timeline with 4 points (moved to this city, started a job, met a friend, started English class). The partner asks *How long have you…? When did you…?* and writes 3 sentences, then tells a new partner (*She's lived here since…*). **Round 2, At the Leasing Office:** A is the agent with a blank form; B answers (invented details are fine); switch. **15:** pairs, then rotate once. **7–8:** pairs, then one rotation. **5 or fewer:** one circle; each person reports on the person to their left.
Listening	**Situation:** a woman applies for an apartment at a leasing office; the agent asks how long she has lived at her current address, about her previous address, and how long she has worked at her job. **Speakers and voices:** Marisol, the applicant (F); Mr. Chen, the leasing agent (M). **Target length:** about 1:45. **Tasks:** A: what is she applying for? B: complete the form (years at each address, employer, start date); C: write *for / since*.
Read & Write	**Read:** a rental application with a short instruction note (about 150 words; invented). **Write:** complete the form for an invented person from a picture profile, then write 5 sentences about how long you (or the invented person) have done three things, with one *used to*.
Exit ticket	*How long have you lived in this city (or worked at your job)?* 3 sentences: how long (*for / since*), when you started (simple past), and why, with *because*. Invented answers are OK.
Pronunciation	Weak *for* /fər/; *since* /sɪns/; linking (*lived_here, worked_at*).
Contrast tip (optional)	Spanish, French, and Portuguese use the present here: *Vivo aquí desde 2019 / hace tres años.* English uses the present perfect: *I've lived here since 2019 / for three years* (not *I live here since 2019*).
Teacher tip	On the board: *since* = a point on the line (●); *for* = a stretch of time (●——●). Learners can invent addresses and jobs. Say "this city" or "this job," never "this country." No questions about income or rent.

Lesson 3 (Week 3): Have You Finished Yet?

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	At work: checking what is done and not done, an end-of-shift handoff, and a short, positive check-in with a supervisor about how the work is going. Employment (performance).
Can-do goals	I can say what I've already done. • I can ask *Have you… yet?* and answer *Not yet.* • I can say what I've just done. • I can answer a supervisor's check-in questions and write a short update email.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** *already / yet / just*: *Have you cleaned the break room yet? → Yes, I've already cleaned it. / No, not yet. I haven't cleaned it yet.* • *Has the truck arrived yet? → Yes, it's just arrived.* • Word place: *already* and *just* go before the past participle; *yet* goes at the end. • **P:** present perfect vs. simple past: *I've finished the orders. I finished them at 3:00.* • **R:** object pronouns *it / them* (Level 3 Lesson 2). • **Rule of thumb:** *already* = done, maybe sooner than expected; *yet* = in questions and *not* sentences; *just* = a very short time ago.
Vocabulary (12)	★ to-do list • ★ task • ★ checklist • ★ supervisor • ★ deadline • ★ restock • ★ inventory • ★ clock in • ★ clock out • ★ break room • ★ feedback • check-in (a short meeting)
Talk Time	**Round 1, Shift Handoff (information gap):** A's checklist shows what is done (✓); B's is blank. B asks *Have you… yet?* and ticks the list; then switch with a second checklist. **Round 2, Check-in:** groups of 3: a supervisor with 3 question cards (*What have you done this week? Have you finished the training yet? What's one thing you'd like to learn?*), a worker, and an observer who ticks *already / yet* on a card; rotate roles. **15:** pairs, then 5 groups of 3. **7–8:** pairs, then 2 groups (the group of 4 has two workers). **5 or fewer:** the teacher plays the supervisor first, then learners take turns.
Listening	**Situation:** the end of the evening shift at a grocery store; the night supervisor checks with two workers what is done (shelves restocked, a delivery put away) and what isn't done yet (the cooler), then gives quick positive feedback. **Speakers and voices:** Ms. Rivera, the supervisor (F); Jamal, a worker (M); Kim, a worker (F). **Target length:** about 2:00. **Tasks:** A: is all the work finished? B: check *done / not yet* on the checklist; C: write *already / yet / just*.
Read & Write	**Read:** an email from a supervisor with a weekly checklist and a reminder about a training deadline (about 170 words; invented). **Write:** a 5–6 sentence reply email: what you've already done, what you haven't done yet, when you'll finish it, and one question. (Writing check 1.)
Exit ticket	*What have you done this week, and what haven't you done yet?* 3 sentences with *already* and *yet*, and one reason.
Pronunciation	Hearing *'s = has* (*It's just arrived*); weak *have* in *Have you… yet?*; stress on *JUST* and *alREADY*.
Contrast tip (optional)	Spanish *ya* can mean *already* (*Ya terminé = I've already finished*) and *yet* in questions (*¿Ya terminaste? = Have you finished yet?*). *Todavía no = not yet*. In English, *yet* goes at the end.
Teacher tip	Draw a checklist on the board and tick items as you say *I've already….* Performance talk stays positive and invented; learners never discuss real problems with real bosses.

Lesson 4 (Week 4): How Long Have You Had It?

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Health: a new-patient health history form, describing a mild, ongoing symptom at a clinic, dental and preventive care (checkups, cleanings, a flu shot), and reading an insurance card (member ID, copay, deductible). Practical and calm.
Can-do goals	I can describe a symptom and say how long I've had it. • I can answer health history questions (*Have you ever had…?*). • I can suggest an idea with *Why don't you…? / You could… / It's a good idea to…* • I can find key information on an insurance card and a clinic letter.
Grammar Q&A focus	**P:** present perfect for health: *How long have you had this rash? → I've had it for three days. / since Monday.* • *Have you ever had surgery? → No, never. / Yes, I had knee surgery in 2018.* • **I:** suggestions: *My back hurts. → Why don't you call the clinic? / You could try a heating pad. / It's a good idea to get a checkup every year.* • **P:** *should* (Level 2) = stronger advice; *could* = a softer idea. • **Rule of thumb:** after *could, why don't you,* and *it's a good idea to*, use the base verb (*call, try, get*).
Vocabulary (12)	★ checkup • ★ health history • ★ symptom • ★ allergy • ★ blood pressure • ★ rash • ★ dizzy • ★ teeth cleaning • ★ cavity • ★ flu shot • ★ prescription • copay • *on the insurance card (Read & Write):* deductible
Talk Time	**Round 1, Clinic Intake (back to back):** A is a medical assistant with an 8-question health history form; B is a patient with an invented symptom card (*a rash for 3 days; a backache since Saturday; a sensitive tooth for a week*); switch. **Round 2, Good Idea Circle:** each learner reads a small problem card (*I sit all day at work.*); the next two people suggest something; the first person chooses one and says why. **15:** pairs, then 3 circles of 5. **7–8:** pairs, then one circle. **5 or fewer:** one circle; the teacher adds cards.
Listening	**Situation:** a patient checks in at a clinic: the medical assistant asks how long she has had back pain, about allergies, and what she has taken; at checkout the receptionist reminds her about a dental cleaning and her copay. **Speakers and voices:** Amina, the patient (F); Daniel, the medical assistant (M); Ms. Park, the receptionist (F). **Target length:** about 2:00. **Tasks:** A: why is she at the clinic? B: complete the form (symptom, since when, allergy); C: write *for / since / ever*.
Read & Write	**Read:** a clinic "Stay healthy" reminder letter (about 180 words: yearly checkup, a dental cleaning every 6 months, bring your insurance card, copay; invented) and an invented insurance card. **Write:** a health history section for an invented patient, then a 3-sentence suggestion note to a friend.
Exit ticket	*A friend has had a backache for a week.* 3 sentences: ask how long, give a suggestion (*Why don't you… / You could…*), and give a reason.
Pronunciation	*Why don't you…?* said as one smooth group, with falling intonation (a suggestion, not a real question); stress on the key words (*I've had a RASH since MONday*).
Contrast tip (optional)	*¿Por qué no llamas…? = Why don't you call…?*: a suggestion, not a real question, in Spanish and many languages. Spanish speakers often say *I have a rash since Monday*; English says *I've had a rash since Monday.*
Teacher tip	All patients and symptoms are invented and mild; never ask learners about their own health, medicines, or insurance. Insurance stays at "read the card; know *copay* and *deductible*" (Decision 3). Say: "For a real health question, ask your doctor or pharmacist. In an emergency, call 911."

Lesson 5 (Week 5): Would You Mind…?

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Asking a neighbor or coworker for a favor: getting the mail and watering the plants while you're away (a spare key, keeping the home safe), switching or covering a shift, borrowing something; saying yes or no politely. Housing (neighbors) and employment (scheduling).
Can-do goals	I can ask for a favor with *Would you mind…?* • I can answer *No, not at all* (= "Yes, I'll help") or say no politely. • I can ask permission with *Do you mind if I…?* • I can ask a coworker to switch a shift and confirm it in writing.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** *Would you mind* + *-ing*: *Would you mind getting my mail on Saturday? → No, not at all. / Sorry, I can't. I'll be away too.* • *Do you mind if I switch my Friday shift? → No, go ahead.* • **Key point:** *No* = "It's not a problem. I'll do it." • **P:** *Can you…? → Could you…? → Would you mind …ing?* (more polite, for bigger favors) • **R:** *I'd like to* (Level 3 Lesson 7): *I'd like to switch my Friday shift.* • **R:** *will* for offers: *Sure, I'll do it.* • **R:** possessive pronouns: *Could I borrow yours?* • **Rule of thumb:** after *mind*, use *-ing*.
Vocabulary (12)	★ favor • ★ borrow • ★ water the plants • ★ feed the cat • ★ get the mail • ★ spare key • ★ package • ★ switch shifts • ★ cover a shift • ★ be away • owe (someone) • thank-you note
Talk Time	**Round 1, Favor Exchange (mingle):** each learner gets a favor card (*get my mail for a week; switch my Saturday shift; lend me a ladder*) and a "my week" card (free / busy). Ask three people; each answers *No, not at all* or *Sorry, I can't, because…* and offers another idea. **Round 2, Shift Switch Text:** pairs write and "send" a 3-sentence text confirming a shift switch, then read it to another pair. **15:** whole-room mingle, then pairs. **7–8:** two lines face each other and move one place each round. **5 or fewer:** a circle; each person asks the person on the left.
Listening	**Situation:** two short scenes: (1) a woman asks her older neighbor to get her mail and water her plants while she's away; he agrees and asks where the spare key will be; (2) a coworker asks her to cover his Saturday shift; she says she can't and suggests another way. **Speakers and voices:** Patricia (F); Mr. Wilson, the neighbor (M, older); Omar, the coworker (M). **Target length:** about 2:00. **Tasks:** A: what favors do they ask for? B: yes or no, and why; C: write the *-ing* word after *mind*.
Read & Write	**Read:** a building notice about packages and a neighbor's note asking a favor (about 160 words; invented). **Write:** a 5–7 sentence email or note to a neighbor asking for a favor while you're away: the dates, what to do, where the key is, thanks, and an offer to help back.
Exit ticket	*Ask a classmate for a favor with* Would you mind…? 3 sentences: your question, their answer, and the reason (*because*).
Pronunciation	Polite intonation; *Would you mind…?* and *Do you mind if I…?* said smoothly, with a friendly rise.
Contrast tip (optional)	In many languages, a *yes* answer means "I'll help." *Would you mind…?* asks "Is it a problem for you?", so **No** means "No problem." Spanish *¿Te importaría…? No, para nada* works the same way.
Teacher tip	Practice the "no = yes" answer first with a thumbs-up: *No, not at all!* All favor cards, keys, and addresses are invented. Shift switches follow each employer's rules: add "Ask your supervisor first."

Lesson 6 (Week 6): What Would You Do?

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Imaginary situations and everyday choices: what you would do if you found money at work, if a cashier gave you too much change, if a coworker were always late, if you had a free week. Learning and thinking skills (problem solving, giving reasons).
Can-do goals	I can ask *What would you do if…?* • I can answer *If I…, I would…* • I can tell a real possibility (*If it rains, I'll…*) from an imaginary one (*If I had a car, I'd…*). • I can explain my choice with a reason.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** second conditional: *What would you do if you found $50 at work? → If I found $50, I'd give it to my supervisor.* • *If I had more time, I'd take a computer class.* • *Would you tell your coworker? → Yes, I would. / No, I wouldn't. I'd talk to my supervisor.* • *If I were you, I'd…* (advice; *were* for every person; teach *If I were*, and accept *If I was* in speaking: Decision 6). • **P:** first vs. second conditional (Level 3 Lesson 6): *If I get the job, I'll buy a car.* (possible) vs. *If I had a car, I'd drive to work.* (imaginary) • **R:** suggestions (Lesson 4). • **Rule of thumb:** imaginary → past form after *if*, *would* in the other half. Never *would* right after *if*.
Vocabulary (12)	★ imagine • ★ choose • ★ honest • ★ tell the truth • ★ keep (it) • ★ give back • ★ owner • ★ envelope • ★ extra money • ★ mistake • magic wand • dream job
Talk Time	**Round 1, What Would You Do? Cards:** groups get 8 everyday cards (*You find $50 on the floor at work. A cashier gives you too much change. Your neighbor's door is open at night. A friend asks you to tell a small lie.*). Each person says what they would do and why; the group finds the most common answer. **Round 2, Magic Wand Chain:** *If I had a magic wand, I'd…* → the next person starts with the last idea (*If I…, I'd…*). **15:** 4 groups of 3–4. **7–8:** 2 groups. **5 or fewer:** one group; the teacher reads the cards.
Listening	**Situation:** a radio call-in segment, "What Would You Do?": the host reads a situation (a cashier gives you $10 too much change); two callers say what they would do and why, and one tells what she actually did once. **Speakers and voices:** Mike, the host (M); Grace, a caller (F); Teresa, a caller (F). **Target length:** about 2:00. **Tasks:** A: what is the situation? B: match caller → choice → reason; C: write *would / 'd / had / were*.
Read & Write	**Read:** a short advice column (about 200 words): a reader asks, "My coworker takes long breaks, and I do extra work. What would you do?" The answer uses *If I were you, I'd….* **Write:** a 5–6 sentence reply to a different letter (*If I were you, I would… because…*).
Exit ticket	*What would you do if you had a free week?* 3 sentences: an *if*-sentence, a second idea, and a reason.
Pronunciation	Hearing *I'd* /aɪd/ vs. *I* (*I'd go / I go*); *wouldn't* /ˈwʊdənt/; *What would you do?* said smoothly, with stress on *DO*.
Contrast tip (optional)	Spanish works the same way: *Si tuviera tiempo, tomaría una clase = If I had time, I'd take a class.* English *would* never changes and never goes right after *if* (not *If I would have time*).
Teacher tip	Choices are light and everyday. Avoid cards about the police, immigration, lending money between classmates, or anything with a "right" answer the teacher grades. Any answer with a reason is a good answer.

Lesson 7 (Week 7): Too Early or On Time?

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Cultural expectations at work and in the community: being on time (how early is early enough), workplace dress codes and safety rules, invitations (RSVP, what to bring), and comparing customs respectfully. Employment (dress codes) and cultural norms and etiquette.
Can-do goals	I can say what is too early, too late, or on time. • I can use *too* and *enough* (*too casual, not formal enough*). • I can use *too much / too many* and *(not) enough* + a noun. • I can explain a workplace rule with *must / mustn't / don't have to*, and compare customs politely.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** *too* + adjective vs. *(not)* adjective + *enough*: *Are jeans OK for the interview? → No, they're too casual. / They aren't formal enough.* • *Is 6:55 early enough? → Yes, that's perfect.* • **I:** *too much / too many / enough* + noun: *There are too many people. I don't have enough time.* (builds on Level 2 count / noncount) • **P:** *must / mustn't / don't have to*: *You must wear closed-toe shoes. You mustn't use your phone on the floor. You don't have to wear a tie.* (*mustn't* = it's against the rules; *don't have to* = it's not necessary) • **R:** frequency words: *People usually arrive on time.* • **Rule of thumb:** *too* = more than OK (a problem); *enough* = OK; *enough* goes **after** an adjective and **before** a noun.
Vocabulary (12)	★ on time • ★ early • ★ late • ★ dress code • ★ uniform • ★ casual • ★ formal • ★ closed-toe shoes • ★ name badge • ★ invitation • ★ RSVP • host
Talk Time	**Round 1, Customs Compare:** groups get question cards (*If a party starts at 7:00, when do people arrive in your hometown? What do guests bring to a dinner? What do people wear to a job interview?*). Each person answers; the group writes 2 sentences comparing (*In my hometown…, but here…*). No place is "better." **Round 2, Dress Code Check:** pairs look at 6 picture cards of workers (a cook in sandals, an office worker in a T-shirt) and a rule card, and say *too casual / not safe enough / OK* with *must / mustn't*. **15:** 5 groups of 3, then pairs. **7–8:** 2 groups, then pairs. **5 or fewer:** one group, then pairs.
Listening	**Situation:** in her first week, a new employee asks an experienced coworker about the workplace: start time ("on time means 5 minutes early"), the uniform, phones, and shoes; the supervisor adds one safety rule. **Speakers and voices:** Nadia, the new employee (F); Carmen, the coworker (F); Mr. Brooks, the supervisor (M). **Target length:** about 2:00. **Tasks:** A: what are they talking about? B: check the rules (*must / mustn't / don't have to*); C: write *too / enough*.
Read & Write	**Read:** an employee handbook page on attendance and dress code (about 200 words; invented company). Answer 5 questions (true / false + *What must you do if you're going to be late?*). **Write:** 5–6 sentences of "Tips for your first week" for a new coworker, with *must, don't have to, too,* and *enough*. (Writing check 2.)
Exit ticket	*What is one custom here that is different from your hometown (or another place you know)?* 3 sentences: here, there, and what you think about it, with a reason.
Pronunciation	*too / two / to* (same sound, different meaning); stress on *TOO late* and *not eNOUGH*; /ʌ/ in *enough*.
Contrast tip (optional)	Spanish *demasiado* covers *too* and *too much / many*: *demasiado caro = too expensive*; *demasiada gente = too many people*. *Suficiente = enough*. English puts *enough* after an adjective: *big enough* (not *enough big*).
Teacher tip	Describe, don't judge: customs vary inside every country, including the U.S. Rules come from each employer; the examples are invented. Keep examples to work, parties, and visits.

Week 8: Midterm (Review Stations + Exam)

See Section 7. Covers Lessons 1–7. No new content.

Lesson 8 (Week 9): In the News

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Understanding short local news reports and city notices (a road closure, a bus detour, a water pipe repair, a new grocery store); talking about what might happen; asking others about local news. Community resources (local news).
Can-do goals	I can understand the main points of a short local news report. • I can say what might or may happen. • I can ask *Do you know where / when / why…?* • I can tell a classmate about a local news story.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** *might / may / could* for possibility: *Will the road be closed tomorrow? → It might be. / It may be closed until Friday. / I'm not sure. It could open next week.* • *might not / may not* • **I (first look):** indirect questions: *Do you know when the new bus route starts? → I think it starts in May. / I'm not sure. It might start in June.* • *Do you know where the meeting is?* (statement order: *where the meeting is*, not *where is the meeting*) • **P:** *will* (sure) vs. *might* (maybe): *The road will close at 8. It might open early.* • **R:** past continuous in news: *Workers were fixing a water pipe when the street flooded.* • **Rule of thumb:** *might / may / could* + base verb, never *to* and never *-s*.
Vocabulary (12)	★ news • ★ reporter • ★ headline • ★ road closure • ★ detour • ★ construction • ★ water pipe • ★ bus route • ★ delay • ★ announce • ★ update • local
Talk Time	**Round 1, News Swap (information gap):** A and B each have a different short local news card with 5 facts. Partners ask *Do you know when / where / why…?* and answer with a fact or *I'm not sure. It might…*; then change partners and retell the story. **Round 2, What Might Happen?:** groups get a headline (*New Grocery Store Opening on Main Street*) and write 4 predictions with *might / may / will probably*, then read them to the class. **15:** pairs, one rotation, then groups of 4. **7–8:** pairs, then 2 groups. **5 or fewer:** pairs, then one group.
Listening	**Situation:** a short local radio news report about a road closure and a bus detour; then two coworkers talk about how it might change their commute and ask each other what they know. **Speakers and voices:** Diane Lee, the news reporter (F); Marco, a coworker (M); Joy, a coworker (F). **Target length:** about 2:00 (report about 0:50, conversation about 1:10). **Tasks:** A: what is the news? B: complete the notes (where, when, how long); C: write *might / will* or the question word.
Read & Write	**Read:** a short local news article about a new bus route (about 200 words; invented city). Find the main idea; answer 5 questions. **Write:** a 5-sentence text or email telling a friend the news, with one *might* and one *Do you know…?*
Exit ticket	*What might change in your neighborhood or at your job next year?* 3 sentences with *might* or *may*, and one reason.
Pronunciation	Weak final /t/ in *might*; rising intonation in *Do you know…?*; listening to a news reader's pace and pauses.
Contrast tip (optional)	Spanish *Puede que cierren la calle* uses a special verb form; English uses *might* + base verb: *They might close the street* (not *might to close*, not *might closes*). Spanish *¿Sabes dónde está…?* keeps the verb right after *dónde*; English moves it: *Do you know where the meeting **is**?*
Teacher tip	Use only invented, neutral local stories (roads, buses, a library, a store opening). No politics, crime, injuries, or real current events. If a learner brings up real news, say "Let's keep to our class stories."

Lesson 9 (Week 10): I See Your Point

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Giving, asking for, and politely disagreeing with an opinion; a neighborhood community meeting about an empty lot (a playground, a parking lot, or a community garden); writing a short opinion paragraph. Community resources (community meetings).
Can-do goals	I can give my opinion with a reason. • I can ask for someone's opinion. • I can agree and disagree politely. • I can compare two ideas with *not as … as*, and write a short opinion paragraph.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I (phrase box):** *What do you think about…? / How do you feel about…? → I think… / In my opinion… / I'm not sure, but…* • *I agree (with you). / That's true. / I see your point, but… / I'm not sure I agree, because…* • **P:** *as … as / not as … as* (builds on Level 2 comparatives): *A garden isn't as expensive as a parking lot. A playground is as important as parking.* • **P:** paragraph words: *First… Also… That's why…* • **R:** second conditional: *If we had a playground, kids would play outside more.* • **Rule of thumb:** to disagree politely, say something positive first (*That's a good idea, but…*). Say *I agree* (not *I am agree*).
Vocabulary (12)	★ opinion • ★ agree • ★ disagree • ★ point (I see your point) • ★ community meeting • ★ empty lot • ★ community garden • ★ parking lot • ★ playground • ★ survey • ★ vote (raise your hand) • advantage / disadvantage
Talk Time	**Round 1, Community Meeting:** groups of 4 are neighbors with role cards (a parent, a store owner, a retired neighbor, a bus rider), each with 2 reasons. Each gives an opinion; the others agree or disagree politely; the group chooses one plan and explains it with 3 reasons. **Round 2, Opinion Lines:** the teacher reads a statement (*Every job should have a uniform. Kids should have less homework.*); learners stand on the *agree*, *not sure*, or *disagree* side and explain, answering someone across the room with *I see your point, but…* **15:** 4 groups (one of 3), then whole-room lines. **7–8:** 2 groups, then lines. **5 or fewer:** one group; the teacher takes a role card.
Listening	**Situation:** a short neighborhood meeting: the meeting leader asks for opinions about an empty lot; one neighbor wants parking, another wants a community garden; they disagree politely and agree to do a survey. **Speakers and voices:** Mrs. Okafor, the meeting leader (F); Ray, a neighbor (M); Lin, a neighbor (F). **Target length:** about 2:15. **Tasks:** A: what are they deciding? B: match person → opinion → reason; C: write the polite phrase (*I see your point / I agree / I'm not sure*).
Read & Write	**Read:** a neighborhood flyer about the meeting and two short opinion letters from the neighborhood newsletter (about 220 words total). **Write:** an opinion paragraph (5–7 sentences) with a frame: topic sentence, two reasons (*First… Also…*), an example, and a closing sentence. (Writing check 3.)
Exit ticket	*Which is better for an empty lot: a playground or a parking lot?* 3 sentences: your opinion, a reason, and *I see the other point, but…*
Pronunciation	Intonation in *I see your point, but…* (fall on *point*, a short pause); contrast stress (*I don't aGREE*; *It isn't as EXpensive*).
Contrast tip (optional)	In some languages, a direct "No, that's wrong" is normal in a discussion. In English, people usually soften it: *I see your point, but…* (Spanish: *Entiendo, pero…*).
Teacher tip	Topics stay local and practical (parks, parking, store hours, bus stops, homework). No elections or political parties. Model disagreeing with a smile, and praise polite language, not who "wins."

Lesson 10 (Week 11): Turn It Off

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Saving energy and keeping a home safe: reading a utility bill, simple ways to use less electricity and water, locking up, and where the fire extinguisher is; giving and following home tips with phrasal verbs. Housing (utilities, saving energy, locks, home safety).
Can-do goals	I can use phrasal verbs like *turn off, turn down, put away*. • I can put *it / them* in the right place (*turn it off*). • I can give tips to save energy and stay safe at home. • I can read the main parts of a utility bill.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** separable phrasal verbs (8): *turn off, turn down, turn up, put on, put away, take out, throw away, shut off.* • *Can you turn off the lights? / turn the lights off? → OK, I'll turn them off.* (not *turn off them*) • *Did you take out the trash? → Yes, I took it out this morning.* • **R:** imperatives + *Make sure you… / Don't forget to…* (Level 3 Lesson 10): *Make sure you turn the stove off.* • **R:** object pronouns *it / them*; *too much* (Lesson 7): *We use too much water.* • **Rule of thumb:** with a noun, two places are OK (*turn off the TV / turn the TV off*); with *it / them*, only the middle (*turn it off*).
Vocabulary (12)	★ utility bill • ★ electricity • ★ thermostat • ★ save energy • ★ unplug • ★ charger • ★ outlet • ★ fan • ★ deadbolt • ★ peephole • ★ fire extinguisher • usage
Talk Time	**Round 1, Energy Detective:** pairs get an apartment picture with 8 energy or safety problems (lights on in an empty room, a window open with the heat on, a charger plugged in, the door not locked). A gives instructions (*Turn them off. Close it. Put it away.*); B points and mimes; switch with a second picture. **Round 2, Home Tips Poster:** groups write 5 tips (*Turn down the heat at night. Unplug the charger.*) and present them in 1 minute. **15:** pairs, then 5 groups of 3. **7–8:** pairs, then 2 groups. **5 or fewer:** pairs, then one poster together.
Listening	**Situation:** two roommates look at a high electric bill and decide how to save energy; then one calls the utility's customer line to ask about the due date and a free energy-saving program. **Speakers and voices:** Sofia, a roommate (F); Hana, a roommate (F); Paul, the customer service agent (M). **Target length:** about 2:00. **Tasks:** A: what is the problem? B: check the tips they choose; C: write the phrasal verb + *it / them*.
Read & Write	**Read:** an invented utility bill (account number, usage, amount due, due date) and a "Save energy, stay safe" flyer from the utility (about 200 words). Answer 5 questions. **Write:** a 5–6 sentence email to a roommate or family member: what to change at home and why.
Exit ticket	*What can people do at home to save energy or stay safe?* 3 sentences with a phrasal verb (one with *it* or *them*) and one reason.
Pronunciation	Stress on the small word in phrasal verbs (*turn it OFF, put it aWAY*); linking (*turn_it_off, take_it_out*).
Contrast tip (optional)	Many languages use one verb where English uses two words: Spanish *apagar = turn off, bajar = turn down, tirar = throw away*. With *it / them*, the small word goes after the pronoun: *turn it off*.
Teacher tip	Safety stays simple and calm: practical tips only, no fire stories. Bills are invented; never ask about learners' bills or rent. Bill-help programs vary; list local ones on the "Keep practicing" sheet.

Lesson 11 (Week 12): Time Off

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Asking for time off at work, planning a short trip to visit family or see a new place, packing, and leaving a detailed voicemail. Employment (time off) and travel and packing.
Can-do goals	I can ask for time off and give a reason. • I can say why with *to* + verb (*to visit my sister*). • I can use verbs + *to* or + *-ing* correctly (*want to go*, *enjoy traveling*). • I can leave a detailed voicemail and write a time-off request email.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** infinitive of purpose: *Why are you taking time off? → To visit my sister in Houston. / I'm going to Houston to see my sister.* • *I'm calling to ask about my vacation days.* • **I:** verb + infinitive vs. verb + *-ing*: **+ to:** *want, need, plan, decide, hope, forget, would like*; **+ -ing:** *enjoy, don't mind, finish, avoid, keep*. *I'm planning to leave on Friday. I enjoy traveling by bus. Don't forget to pack your charger.* • **P:** brings Level 3's *enjoy / don't mind* + *-ing* and *hope to / plan to* together in one chart. • **R:** *going to* for plans; *Would you mind covering my shift?* (Lesson 5); *already / yet* (*I've already packed*). • **Rule of thumb:** there is no rule for which verbs take *to* and which take *-ing*; learn the two short lists in the box. *to* + verb also answers *Why?*
Vocabulary (12)	★ time off • ★ vacation days • ★ request form • ★ approve • ★ pack • ★ suitcase • ★ carry-on bag • ★ round-trip ticket • ★ boarding pass • ★ toiletries • ★ voicemail • itinerary
Talk Time	**Round 1, Trip Planner:** pairs get a trip card (*visit family in another state for 4 days; a weekend at a lake*). They plan why (*to…*), what they want to do and enjoy doing, and what to pack (*too much / enough*), and fill in a time-off request. **Round 2, Voicemail Relay (back to back):** A "leaves a voicemail" of 30–45 seconds (name, reason for calling, dates, an invented callback number); B takes notes and reads them back; switch. **15:** pairs, then back-to-back rows. **7–8:** pairs, then one rotation. **5 or fewer:** pairs; the teacher checks the notes.
Listening	**Situation:** (1) a worker asks his supervisor for three days off to visit his mother, and they check who can cover his shifts; (2) he leaves a detailed voicemail for his sister (arrival day, time, bus number, what to bring), and she calls back. **Speakers and voices:** Luis, the worker (M); Ms. Adams, the supervisor (F); Rosa, his sister (F). **Target length:** about 2:15. **Tasks:** A: why does he need time off? B: complete the request and voicemail notes (dates, reason, who covers, arrival time); C: write *to* or *-ing*.
Read & Write	**Read:** a company time-off policy (about 180 words: ask 2 weeks ahead, use the form, the supervisor approves; invented) and a packing list. **Write:** a 6–8 sentence email to a supervisor asking for time off: the dates, the reason (*to…*), who can cover (*Ana has agreed to cover my shift*), and thanks. (Writing check 4.)
Exit ticket	*Where would you like to go on a trip, and why?* 3 sentences: one with *to* + verb (why), one with *enjoy* + *-ing*, and one more reason.
Pronunciation	Reductions: *want to → wanna, going to → gonna* (understand them; saying them is optional; never write them); saying a phone number in groups (3-3-4) with pauses.
Contrast tip (optional)	Spanish uses *para* for purpose: *Voy a Houston para ver a mi hermana.* English uses only *to*: *I'm going to Houston to see my sister* (not *for see*, not *for to see*). After *enjoy*, use *-ing*: *I enjoy traveling* (not *enjoy to travel*).
Teacher tip	Trips can be invented; don't assume learners can travel or have paid vacation days. No passport, visa, or immigration topics. Time-off rules vary by employer; the policy is invented.

Lesson 12 (Week 13): Is It a Scam?

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Consumer protection: recognizing common scams by phone, text, and email (a fake prize, a fake bank text, a fake "pay your bill today" call, payment with gift cards) and what to do: stop, don't pay, check with the real company, and tell someone. Practical and calm.
Can-do goals	I can describe a person or a message with *who / that*. • I can name 4 warning signs of a scam. • I can say what to do if I get a suspicious call or text. • I can warn a friend or family member in a short message.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** defining relative clauses (subject *who / that*): *What's a scam? → It's a trick that takes your money.* • *Who called you? → A man who said he was from the bank.* • *Be careful with texts that ask for your password.* • *Don't trust a caller who asks you to pay with gift cards.* • *who* for people; *that* for things (and also people). • **P:** *something / anyone* (Level 3 Lesson 12): *Never give your PIN to anyone. If something sounds too good to be true, it probably is.* • **R:** *must / mustn't, should*. • **Rule of thumb:** the *who / that* part tells you **which** person or thing; don't add *he / it* after it (*a man who called*, not *a man who he called*).
Vocabulary (12)	★ scam • ★ warning sign • ★ suspicious • ★ fake • ★ official • ★ gift card • ★ prize • ★ link • ★ PIN • ★ hang up • ★ block (a number) • trust
Talk Time	**Round 1, Real or Scam? Sort:** pairs get 10 invented message cards (texts, emails, call notes) and sort them into *probably real* and *probably a scam*, explaining with *It's a text that… / It's from someone who…*; then compare with another pair. **Round 2, Safe Answer Role-Play:** A is a caller with a pushy (but polite) script card; B practices a safe answer (*I don't give information on the phone. I'll call the number on my card. Goodbye.*); switch. **15:** pairs, then groups of 4 to compare, then pairs. **7–8:** pairs, then one group to compare. **5 or fewer:** the whole group sorts together, then pairs.
Listening	**Situation:** a woman gets a call from someone who says he's from "the electric company" and that she must pay today with gift cards; she says no and hangs up, tells her adult son, then calls the number on her real bill and learns her account is fine. No money is lost. **Speakers and voices:** Mrs. Lopez (F); the caller (M); her son, Daniel (M); the real utility agent (F). No more than 3 speakers in one scene. **Target length:** about 2:00. **Tasks:** A: was it a scam? B: check the warning signs you heard; C: write *who / that*.
Read & Write	**Read:** a "Smart Consumer Tips" flyer from an invented community office (about 200 words: 5 warning signs, 4 steps) and a sample scam text. **Write:** a 5–6 sentence message to a family member about a scam text, with *that / who* and *Don't….*
Exit ticket	*What is one warning sign of a scam, and what should you do?* 3 sentences with *who* or *that*, and one reason.
Pronunciation	Weak *that* /ðət/ in relative clauses; stress on the key words (*NEVER, GIFT cards*); a calm, firm tone for *No, thank you. Goodbye.*
Contrast tip (optional)	Spanish uses *que* for people and things: *el hombre que llamó, el mensaje que llegó.* English uses *who* (or *that*) for people and *that* for things: *the man who called, the message that came.* Many languages repeat the pronoun (*the man who he called*); English doesn't.
Teacher tip	Keep it calm and practical: "Most calls and texts are real. A few are scams. Stop, check, and ask." No scary stories; never ask learners whether they lost money. All messages are invented, with no real numbers or links. List a local consumer-help line on the "Keep practicing" sheet (check it locally). **Teacher-only (Decision 4):** if asked about fake "legal help" or "immigration help" services, point only to local legal aid.

Lesson 13 (Week 14): My Story So Far

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Telling life events in order with *before, after, when*: what you couldn't do then, what you've done since, and what you'll do next; preparing the 2-minute graduation talk. Learning skills and basic communication.
Can-do goals	I can tell events in order with *before / after / when*. • I can say what I could or couldn't do (*couldn't / was able to*). • I can connect past and present (*I used to…, but now I've…*). • I can give a 2-minute talk about my story and my next step.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** time clauses: *When I started this job, I didn't know anyone.* • *After I finished my shift, I came to class.* • *Before I started this class, I couldn't fill out an application.* • *What did you do after you finished school? → After I finished school, I worked in a store.* • Comma rule: time clause first → comma; time clause second → no comma. • Future: *After I finish this class, I'll take Level 5.* (present after *when / after / before*, like *if*) • **P:** past ability: *When I started, I couldn't understand the bus driver. Now I can. Last month I was able to call the clinic by myself.* • **P:** past continuous: *I was working at a restaurant when I met my best friend.* • **R:** *used to*, present perfect, *will / going to*. • **Rule of thumb:** *before / after / when* + a full sentence; the two halves can change places.
Vocabulary (12)	★ milestone • ★ challenge • ★ succeed • ★ confident • ★ get used to • ★ make friends • ★ be able to • ★ support • ★ celebrate • ★ timeline • speech • audience
Talk Time	**Round 1, Story Timeline:** each learner puts 5 events on a timeline (real or partly invented) and tells a partner with *when / before / after*; the partner asks 2 follow-ups. **Round 2, Talk Rehearsal:** groups of 3 rehearse the 2-minute talk with a timer; listeners give one strength and one tip on a feedback card. **15:** pairs, then 5 groups of 3. **7–8:** pairs, then 2–3 groups. **5 or fewer:** pairs, then everyone rehearses for the whole group.
Listening	**Situation:** a former Level 4 learner gives a short graduation talk (when she started, what was hard, what she can do now, her next step); then the teacher asks her two questions. **Speakers and voices:** Mariana, the former learner (F); Mr. Hill, the teacher (M). **Target length:** about 2:00. **Tasks:** A: what is her main message? B: put 5 events in order; C: write *before / after / when*.
Read & Write	**Read:** a learner's story from a class newsletter (about 230 words). Mark the time words and answer 4 questions. **Write:** the graduation talk (12–15 sentences, about 2 minutes) with the talk frame: Then → What was hard and what I've done → Now → Next, with a reason. Finish at home. (Writing check 5.)
Exit ticket	*Write about one change in your life.* 3 sentences: when it happened, what you couldn't do before, and what you can do now, with a reason.
Pronunciation	A short pause at the comma after a time clause; thought groups in a speech; slowing down for key words.
Contrast tip (optional)	Spanish uses a special verb form after *cuando* for the future: *Cuando termine la clase…*; English uses the present: *When I finish this class, I'll…* (not *When I will finish*). Same rule as *if* in Lesson 6 and Level 3.
Teacher tip	Stories are the learner's choice; "my life in this class" or "my job" is always enough. Never ask about migration journeys, family separation, or hard events. Model your own 1-minute version first. Reading from paper is OK at graduation.

Week 15: Final Exam · Week 16: Graduation

See Section 7.

7. Midterm, Final, and Graduation

Same evening structure as Level 3 (Opening → review stations with speaking interviews → listening test before the break → grammar and writing after the break → can-do self-check). Level 4 changes: the listening test uses longer audio with some reductions (still played **2 times**), the writing task is an **email** at the midterm and an **opinion paragraph or email** at the final, and the speaking interview includes a **reason and a response to the partner**.

	Week 8: Midterm	Week 15: Final
Covers	Lessons 1–7: present perfect with *ever / never*, *for / since*, *already / yet / just*; present perfect vs. simple past; suggestions (*could, why don't you, it's a good idea to*); *Would you mind…?*; second conditional; *too / enough*, *too much / too many*; *must / mustn't / don't have to*	All lessons, focus on 8–13: *might / may / could*; *Do you know where…?*; opinions and *as … as*; separable phrasal verbs; infinitive of purpose; verb + *to* / *-ing*; *who / that*; *before / after / when*; *could / was able to*
Review stations (6:10–6:30)	① Grammar Auction (correct / wrong sentences), ② Listening Replay (Lessons 4–7 audio), ③ Role-Play Cards (one per lesson), ④ Pronunciation Bingo (*I've / I'd / haven't / wouldn't*)	① Grammar Auction, ② Listening Replay (Lessons 10–13), ③ Role-Play Cards, ④ Talk Rehearsal (graduation talk)
Listening test (6:30–6:45)	10 items: a clinic check-in (*How long have you had…?*) and a favor between neighbors (main idea, details, grammar word). Circle / true-false / write one word. The teacher plays the audio 2 times.	10 items: a local news report, a time-off voicemail, and a scam call that the listener hangs up on. Same task types.
Grammar test (7:00–7:15)	20 items: 15 circle the answer (*have / has* + participle, *for / since*, *did / have*, *already / yet*, *would / will*, *too / enough*, *much / many*, *mind + -ing*, *mustn't / don't have to*), 5 fix the mistake	20 items: 15 circle (*might* + base verb, *where the meeting is / where is the meeting*, *turn it off / turn off it*, *to visit / for visit*, *enjoy traveling / enjoy to travel*, *who / that*, *before / after / when*, *could / was able to*), 5 fix the mistake
Writing task (7:15–7:28)	A 5–6 sentence email: an update to a supervisor (*already / yet*) **or** a favor to a neighbor (*Would you mind…?*) (choose one), with one reason	A 5–7 sentence opinion paragraph on a community topic **or** a 6–8 sentence time-off email (choose one), with reasons
Speaking interview (4 min per pair)	Part 1: 2 baseline prompts each, with one follow-up from the interviewer. Part 2: a pair task card: a clinic intake (*How long have you had…?*) **or** a *What would you do?* card, with reasons	Part 1: the same baseline prompts as Weeks 1–3, to show growth. Part 2: an opinion exchange (agree and disagree politely) **or** a safe answer to a scam call
Rubric	Level 3's 1–3 rubric (Communication / Target grammar / Pronunciation and fluency). For Level 4, a **3 in Communication** means the learner answers in about **3 connected sentences with a reason and** responds to the partner (a follow-up question, or polite agreement or disagreement).	Same
Self-check	Can-do self-check + one goal	Can-do self-check; "Ready for Level 5" decision

Exam-night timing with 15 learners: 8 pairs × 4 minutes ≈ 32 minutes of interviews. Start them during the

> review stations and continue during the grammar and writing tests. With 7–8 learners, about 16 minutes.

Proposed "Ready for Level 5" standard (confirm): attend at least 9 of the 13 lessons, complete the final, score 2 or higher in all rubric areas on the final speaking interview, and write an email or paragraph of at least 5 sentences that a reader can understand on the first reading. Learners who are not ready still graduate and are encouraged to repeat Level 4.

Week 16: Graduation. No new content. Each learner gives a **2-minute "My Story So Far" talk** prepared in Lesson 13 (reading from paper is fine; learners who need it may give a shorter talk). Certificates of completion. Optional potluck: ask about allergies, and don't require anyone to bring food. Hand out a "Keep practicing" sheet with the website, QR codes for all audio, and local community resources (adult education, library, consumer help, bill-help programs).

8. Decisions (approved October 22, 2026)

The seven open questions from the review are now decisions. The lesson build follows them.

1. **Task-words page:** an optional page at the **back** of each Level 4 workbook.
2. **Contrast tip:** an optional box **only on Grammar pages where a common mix-up exists** (written for any language, with Spanish as one example). Pages without a common mix-up have no box.
3. **Lesson 4 insurance:** stays at **reading the card** and the words ***copay*** and ***deductible***. Insurance claims stay in Level 5.
4. **Lesson 12 scams:** add a **short teacher-only note** on fake legal-help and immigration-help services, pointing only to local legal aid. Nothing on student pages.
5. **Audio reductions:** the recordings say ***going to*** and ***want to***. The Hear It box still explains that people often say ***gonna*** and ***wanna***, and that learners only need to recognize those short forms. They never have to say or write them. Other reduced forms are not taught; the pronunciation rows in Section 6 were adjusted to match.
6. **Lesson 6:** teach ***If I were***; **accept *If I was* in speaking**.
7. **"Ready for Level 5" standard:** stays as drafted in Section 7.

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